

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588**Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88**

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

Key topic 2: Challenges to Elizabeth at home and abroad, 1569–88

1 Plots and revolts at home	- The reasons for, and significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70. - The features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots. Walsingham and the use of spies. - The reasons for, and significance of, Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.
2 Relations with Spain	- Political, religious and commercial rivalry. - The significance of privateering and the activities of Drake.
3 Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	- Reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain: English direct involvement in the Netherlands and the actions of Robert Dudley. - Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.
4 The Armada	- Spanish invasion plans. Key events of the Spanish Armada. - The reasons for the English victory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

NOV 1569 • Revolt of the Northern Earls

Key Topic 2.1

Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland march on Durham Cathedral, tear up English bibles, and restore the Latin Mass with 4,600 men. Royal troops march north; the rebellion collapses and Elizabeth executes 450 rebels to crush northern disobedience.

FEB 1570 • Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*

Key Topic 2.1

Pope Pius V issues a papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth, declaring her a 'pretended queen' and heretic. Crucially, the Pope releases all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance, making it a sacred Catholic duty to overthrow the Queen.

1571–1583 • The Ridolfi and Throckmorton Plots

Key Topic 2.1

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans a Spanish invasion by the Duke of Alba to marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk. In 1583, French Catholic Francis Throckmorton coordinates a planned invasion backed by Spain and the Pope. Walsingham uncovers both.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

AUG 1585 • The Treaty of Nonsuch & Open War with Spain

Key Topic 2.3

Following the assassination of Dutch Protestant leader William of Orange, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels, agreeing to send 7,400 troops under Robert Dudley. This ends decades of cold war and triggers open military conflict with Spain.

1586–FEB 1587 • The Babington Plot & Execution of Mary Stuart

Key Topic 2.1

Anthony Babington sends coded letters in beer barrels to Mary Stuart agreeing to assassinate Elizabeth. Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes intercepts Mary's endorsement. Mary is convicted of high treason and beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle on 8 Feb 1587.

APR 1587–AUG 1588 • Drake at Cadiz & Defeat of the Spanish Armada

Key Topic 2.4

Drake raids Cadiz harbour, destroying 30 Spanish ships ('singeing the King's beard') and delaying the Armada by a year. In July 1588, 130 Spanish ships enter the Channel. English fireships break their formation at Calais; Gravelines artillery seals English victory.

Why did every Catholic plot to assassinate Elizabeth end in catastrophic failure?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 NOV 1569–JAN 1570 The Revolt of the Northern Earls • Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland lead 4,600 armed men in open rebellion. • Rebels occupy Durham Cathedral, celebrate Latin Mass, and tear up English prayer books. • Earl of Sussex marches north with 14,000 royal troops; earls flee to Scotland.	<i>Why did the Northern Earls fail to overthrow Elizabeth despite capturing Durham Cathedral?</i>
2 1570–1571 Papal Bull & The Ridolfi Plot • Feb 1570: Pope Pius V issues Papal Bull Regnans in Excelsis excommunicating Elizabeth. • Roberto Ridolfi: Italian banker liaising between Duke of Norfolk, Philip II, and Mary Stuart. • Plan: 10,000 Spanish troops under Alba land in England, marry Mary to Norfolk, and take throne.	<i>How did the 1570 Papal Bull transform the legal and political danger facing English Catholics?</i>
3 1583–1584 The Throckmorton Plot & Bond of Association • Francis Throckmorton: Catholic intermediary between French Duke of Guise, Philip II, and Mary. • Sir Francis Walsingham uncovers plot through surveillance and interrogation in Tower. • 1584: Privy Council and Parliament draw up the Bond of Association.	<i>Why did the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot lead to harsher anti-Catholic measures?</i>
4 1586 The Babington Plot & Walsingham's Spies • Anthony Babington: wealthy Catholic leading plot to assassinate Elizabeth with foreign backing. • Letters hidden inside beer barrels smuggled into Mary's residence at Chartley Manor. • Thomas Phelippes: Walsingham's codebreaker intercepts and deciphers all letters.	<i>How did Walsingham use espionage and deciphered correspondence to trap Mary Stuart?</i>
5 FEB 1587 The Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots • Oct 1586: Mary tried at Fotheringhay Castle under the Act for the Queen's Safety (1585). • Parliament and Privy Council petition Elizabeth to sign the death warrant. • 8 Feb 1587: Mary executed in the Great Hall at Fotheringhay Castle.	<i>Why was Elizabeth so reluctant to execute Mary Queen of Scots despite proven treason?</i>

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Target Guidance: Point (A Catholic uprising led by the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland to restore Catholicism) • Fact (They held a Latin Mass in Durham Cathedral with 4,600 men, but fled when royal troops advanced; 450 rebels were executed).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the northern Catholic nobles' attempt to overthrow Protestantism... Specifically, they captured Durham Cathedral and...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network.

Target Guidance: Point (An extensive intelligence network of spies, informers, codebreakers, and cryptographers) • Fact (Walsingham intercepted letters, cracked ciphers with Thomas Phelippes, and deployed double agents across England and Europe).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Walsingham's systematic interception of secret communications... Specifically, his cryptographer Thomas Phelippes...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571).

Target Guidance: Point (A conspiracy led by Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi to assassinate Elizabeth and place Mary on the throne) • Fact (Planned for 10,000 Spanish troops under the Duke of Alba to invade; Cecil uncovered the cipher letters and the Duke of Norfolk was executed).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the conspiracy to depose Elizabeth with Spanish military backing... Specifically, the plotters planned to...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the beer barrel with hidden cipher letters and the execution block at Fotheringhay.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2)

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2)

★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587.

You may use in your answer:

- The Babington Plot (1586)

- Walsingham's spy network

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CAUSE 1: DIRECT COMPLICITY IN BABINGTON PLOT

POINT
1

Explain that intercepted beer-barrel letters explicitly showed Mary endorsing Anthony Babington's plot to assassinate Elizabeth; Phelippes decoded Mary's letter containing the postmark gallows sign.

2. CAUSE 2: WALSINGHAM & PARLIAMENTARY PRESSURE

POINT
2

Explain that the 1584 Bond of Association legally obligated privy councillors to execute anyone involved in assassination plots; Parliament and Cecil relentlessly lobbied Elizabeth to sign the death warrant.

3. CAUSE 3: ESCALATING SPANISH WAR THREAT

POINT
3

Explain that by 1586 England was at open war with Spain following the Treaty of Nonsuch; keeping Mary alive created an immediate rallying figure for an imminent Spanish invasion of England.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Continued

VERDICT

[illegible]

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 1570–1577 Political and Religious Rivalry with Spain • Philip II of Spain: leader of Catholic Counter-Reformation and ruler of vast global empire. • Spanish Netherlands: English cloth export trade centered on Antwerp. • Sea Beggars: Dutch rebel privateers granted temporary shelter in English ports.	Why did Spanish control of the Netherlands threaten English trade and security?
2 1570–1579 Commercial Rivalry in the New World • Spanish trade monopoly: English merchants forbidden from trading with colonies without license. • Privateering: English armed merchant ships raiding Spanish treasure fleets and ports. • 1572: Francis Drake raids Nombre de Dios on Isthmus of Panama, seizing £20,000 in silver.	Why did English privateering in the Caribbean inflame diplomatic tensions with Spain?
3 1577–1580 Drake's Circumnavigation • Dec 1577: Drake departs Plymouth with five ships on Pelican (renamed Golden Hind). • Captures Spanish treasure ship Cacafuego carrying 80lb of gold and 26 tons of silver. • Returns to Plymouth in Sept 1580 with £140,000 in treasure, enriching royal finances.	Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?
4 1581–1584 Escalation & Elizabeth's Defiance • April 1581: Elizabeth publicly knights Drake on board the Golden Hind at Deptford. • 1580: Philip II annexes Portugal, gaining the Portuguese navy and Atlantic coastline. • 1584: Assassination of Dutch rebel leader William the Silent; death of Duke of Alençon.	How did events in Europe between 1580 and 1584 increase the threat of a Spanish invasion?
5 1584–1585 The Treaties of Joinville & Nonsuch • Dec 1584: Treaty of Joinville signed between Philip II and the French Catholic League. • Aug 1585: Elizabeth signs Treaty of Nonsuch, sending 7,400 English troops to Netherlands. • Oct 1585: Drake dispatched with 25 ships to attack Spanish ports in Vigo and Caribbean.	Why did the Treaty of Nonsuch mark the point of no return for war between England and Spain?

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] MEDIUM FREQUENCY

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World.

Target Guidance: Point (Spain held an exclusive trade monopoly on its American colonies that barred English merchants) • Fact (English privateers like John Hawkins and Drake bypassed Spanish licenses to trade illegally and seize Spanish bullion ships).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Spanish trade restrictions in the Caribbean... Specifically, Spain banned English merchants, prompting privateers like Drake to...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION
FOCUSEdexcel November 2021
(Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579).

Target Guidance: Point (Drake captured Spain's richest treasure galleon in the Pacific during his circumnavigation) • Fact (He seized 80lb of gold, 26 tons of silver, and jewels worth £140,000, bringing it back to Elizabeth on the Golden Hind).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the colossal value of the treasure seized... Specifically, Drake intercepted the treasure ship off Ecuador and took...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION
FOCUSEdexcel Specification
Focus

Describe one key feature of English privateering against Spanish treasure fleets.

Target Guidance: Point (Elizabeth secretly backed English captains to capture Spanish silver without open declaration of war) • Fact (Captains like Francis Drake held royal letters of marque, bringing vast riches to England and crippling Philip II's Atlantic supply lines).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the covert state sponsorship of privateering raids... Specifically, English privateers...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch Drake's ship the *Golden Hind* and the Spanish silver bars.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2023
(Q3A)

**CORE EXAM
FOCUS**

Score: [/ 20]

‘Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening relations between England and Spain between 1569 and 1585.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • Religious conflict *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: COMMERCIAL RIVALRY & DRAKE

**POINT
1**

Explain how Drake's raids in the West Indies and Pacific humiliated Philip II; by knighting Drake in 1581 and funding privateers, Elizabeth demonstrated state sponsorship of piracy against Spanish bullion.

2. CRITERIA 2: RELIGIOUS ANTAGONISM

POINT 2

Explain that Philip viewed himself as the secular sword of the Catholic Counter-Reformation; the 1570 papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth and Philip's backing of plots (Ridolfi, Throckmorton) made holy war inevitable.

3. CRITERIA 3: THE STRATEGIC NETHERLANDS CRISIS

POINT
3

Explain that Spain's military brutality in the Netherlands (Alba and Parma) threatened England's chief wool export market; Spanish control of Channel ports was an intolerable direct invasion threat.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Continued

VERDICT

[illegible]

Did English intervention in the Netherlands or Drake's raid on Cadiz make the Armada inevitable?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 DEC 1585–1586 Dudley's Campaign in the Netherlands • Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester, leads 7,400 English soldiers to the Netherlands. • Dudley accepts title of 'Governor-General' of United Provinces without royal approval. • Duke of Parma: highly skilled commander leading experienced Spanish Army of Flanders.	<i>Why did Dudley's campaign in the Netherlands struggle to achieve decisive military success?</i>
2 1586–1587 Military Setbacks: Zutphen & Deventer • Sept 1586: Sir Philip Sidney fatally wounded at the Battle of Zutphen. • Jan 1587: English commander Sir William Stanley surrenders town of Deventer to Spain. • Late 1587: Dudley recalled to England after disputes with Dutch rebel leaders.	<i>How did English betrayals and command disputes damage relations with the Dutch rebels?</i>
3 APRIL 1587 Drake's Raid on Cadiz • April 1587: Elizabeth orders Drake to attack Spanish naval preparations. • Drake sails directly into Cadiz harbor; sinks and burns over 30 Spanish ships. • Raids coast of Portugal; captures treasure ship San Felipe carrying £108,000 in cargo.	<i>How did Drake's tactical boldness at Cadiz disrupt the Spanish invasion timetable?</i>
4 1587–1588 Impact of the Cadiz Raid • Destruction of seasoned wooden barrel staves along the Portuguese coast. • Marquis of Santa Cruz: Spain's veteran naval admiral dies during invasion delays. • Philip II appoints Duke of Medina Sidonia as new commander-in-chief of Armada.	<i>Why were logistical damage and command changes fatal to the Spanish invasion plan?</i>
5 MAY–JULY 1588 The Armada Sets Sail • May 1588: Armada of 130 ships, 2,431 cannons, and 30,000 men departs Lisbon. • Forced into port at Corunna for repairs following severe Atlantic storms. • Invasion plan: sail up Channel, join Parma's 27,000 troops, and cross to Kent.	<i>What strategic flaws made Philip II's plan to link the fleet with Parma extremely risky?</i>

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585).

Target Guidance: Point (An official military alliance committing England to support Dutch Protestant rebels against Spain) • Fact (Elizabeth sent 7,400 soldiers under the Earl of Leicester and financed their campaign, officially ending covert neutrality).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was England's formal military commitment to the Dutch rebels... Specifically, Elizabeth agreed to send...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Not examined since 2019)

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Target Guidance: Point (A surprise pre-emptive attack on Spain's primary naval staging base at Cadiz) • Fact (Drake destroyed 30 Spanish warships and tons of seasoned barrel staves, delaying the sailing of the Armada by over 12 months).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was the devastating destruction of Spanish naval shipping... Specifically, Drake sailed directly into Cadiz harbour and...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Joinville (1584).

Target Guidance: Point (A secret alliance between Philip II of Spain and the French Catholic League) • Fact (Both parties agreed to eradicate Protestantism, isolating England and removing France as a counterweight against Spanish aggression).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was the secret Catholic alliance signed between Spain and France... Specifically, the Treaty of Joinville meant that...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch the Dutch Protestant rebel banner and the Treaty of Nonsuch seal.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

**EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020
(Q2)**

★ HIGH-YIELD
FORECAST

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels in 1585.

You may use in your answer:

- The assassination of William of Orange

- The Treaty of Joinville

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CAUSE 1: ASSASSINATION OF WILLIAM OF ORANGE

POINT
1

Explain that the murder of William the Silent in July 1584 left the Dutch rebellion leaderless and facing total collapse; if the Dutch fell, Parma's veteran Spanish army would turn directly on England.

2. CAUSE 2: THE TREATY OF JOINVILLE & ISOLATION

POINT
2

Explain that in Dec 1584 Spain and France signed the Treaty of Joinville, uniting the two Catholic superpowers; England faced total diplomatic encirclement and could no longer play France off against Spain.

3. CAUSE 3: STRATEGIC CONTROL OF CHANNEL PORTS

**POINT
3**

Explain that deep-water Dutch ports like Antwerp, Flushing, and Brill lay directly opposite the Thames estuary; Elizabeth had to secure these ports to prevent an invasion springboard into southern England.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88 • Question 2 Continued INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL VERDICT

**INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL
HISTORICAL VERDICT**

[illegible]

Why did the Spanish Armada fail: superior English tactics or disastrous Spanish planning?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 JULY 1588 Channel Battles: Plymouth to Isle of Wight • 130 Spanish ships enter English Channel in a rigid defensive crescent formation. • Lord Howard of Effingham and Drake shadow the Armada, firing at long range. • Medina Sidonia attempts to secure safe deep-water anchorage off Isle of Wight.	Why were English ships unable to break the Armada's crescent formation in open Channel water?
2 7-8 AUG 1588 Calais Roads & The Fireships • 6 Aug: Armada anchors off Calais; Parma's barges blockaded at Dunkirk by Dutch flyboats. • Midnight, 7 Aug: English deploy eight blazing fireships packed with pitch and gunpowder. • Spanish captains cut anchor cables and scatter into dark waters of North Sea.	Why did the English use of fireships at Calais prove the decisive turning point of the campaign?
3 8 AUG 1588 The Battle of Gravelines • English race-built galleons engage scattered Spanish ships at close range (100 meters). • English culverins on compact naval trucks reload and fire multiple broadsides rapidly. • Spanish heavy siege cannons mounted on two-wheeled land carriages reload slowly.	How did English ship design and gunnery tactics defeat Spanish warships at Gravelines?
4 AUG-SEPT 1588 The Winds & Atlantic Retreat • Strong south-westerly gales drive battered Armada north past Scotland into Atlantic. • Spanish ships lack anchors, fresh water, and food due to rotten unseasoned barrels. • Over 40 Spanish ships wrecked along rocky coasts of Scotland and western Ireland.	Why did the combination of adverse weather and lost equipment destroy the retreating Armada?
5 1588-1589 Consequences of the English Victory • Only 67 of 130 Spanish ships return to Spain; thousands of Spanish sailors perish. • Elizabeth delivers Tilbury speech; commemorative Armada portrait and medal commissioned. • War with Spain continues for another 16 years until Treaty of London (1604).	How did the defeat of the Armada transform Elizabeth's reputation at home and abroad?

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] MEDIUM FREQUENCY Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Spanish invasion plan of 1588.

Target Guidance: Point (A joint operation requiring the Armada to rendezvous with the Duke of Parma's army in the Netherlands) • Fact (Medina Sidonia had to transport Parma's 27,000 veteran soldiers across the Channel on flat-bottomed barges to invade Kent).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the coordination required between fleet and army... Specifically, Medina Sidonia was ordered to rendezvous with Parma at...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588).

Target Guidance: Point (Eight burning ships filled with pitch and gunpowder were launched into the anchored Spanish fleet) • Fact (Spanish captains panicked, cut their anchor cables, and broke their defensive crescent formation, scattering into the open sea).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the psychological panic caused by the fireships... Specifically, Spanish captains cut their anchors and broke...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of English naval tactics during the Armada campaign.

Target Guidance: Point (English ships utilized superior maneuverability and long-range gunnery) • Fact (English race-built galleons kept out of Spanish grappling range, pounding Spanish vessels with culverin broadsides and causing severe damage at Gravelines).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the reliance on long-distance artillery rather than boarding... Specifically, English commanders...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch the blazing fireships drifting into Calais Roads and the shattered Spanish galleon.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

**EDEXCEL JUNE 2019
(Q3B)**

★ HIGH-YIELD
FORECAST

Score: [/ 20]

'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior English naval tactics and technology.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

- English fireships at Calais
- Spanish planning and leadership

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: ENGLISH TACTICS & SHIP DESIGN

POINT
1

Explain how Hawkins' race-built galleons outmaneuvered clumsy Spanish carracks, using long-range culverins on four-wheeled truck carriages to reload and fire broadsides rapidly at Gravelines.

2. CRITERIA 2: FLAWED SPANISH INVASION PLANNING

POINT
2

Explain that Philip II's plan was fatally flawed: Parma controlled no deep-water port in the Netherlands, meaning communication took 48 hours by horse and barges could not escape Dutch flyboat blockades.

3. CRITERIA 3: ADVERSE WEATHER & THE "PROTESTANT WIND"

POINT 3

Explain that south-westerly gales drove the scattered Spanish fleet into the hazardous North Sea; lacking anchors lost at Calais, dozens of galleons were wrecked on the jagged rocks of Scotland and Ireland.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 2.4: The Armada • Question 3 Continued

INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL VERDICT

[illegible]

"Sustained conclusion: explain why the Protestant Wind finished what English gunnery started."

THEMATIC STUDY BLUEPRINT • KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES AT HOME & ABROAD, 1569–88

1. THE STRATEGIC ROUTE OF THE SPANISH ARMADA: PLYMOUTH TO GRAVELINES & THE ATLANTIC RETREAT

- ① **The Channel (July 1588):** 130 Spanish ships in defensive crescent sail past Plymouth and Isle of Wight. English culverins fire from standoff range with minor damage.
- ② **Calais Roads (7 Aug):** Armada anchors awaiting Parma. Midnight English fireships cause panic; Spanish cut anchor cables and break defensive formation.
- ③ **Gravelines (8 Aug):** Close-range artillery battle. Nimble English race-built galleons batter scattered Spanish ships with rapid culverin broadsides; 5 galleons sunk.
- ④ **The Retreat (Aug–Sept):** South-westerly gales drive Armada around Scotland and Ireland. Lacking anchors, over 40 ships wreck on Atlantic rocky coasts.

2. NAVAL ARCHITECTURE: HAWKINS' RACE-BUILT GALLEONS VS SPANISH IMPERIAL CARRACKS

- gb English Race-Built Galleon (*Revenge*, *Ark Royal*)**

 - **Design:** John Hawkins removed high forecastles; streamlined hull for speed and sailing close to wind.
 - **Artillery:** Long-range bronze **culverins** on 4-wheel truck carriages for rapid reloading inside ship.
 - **Gunnery Doctrine:** Stand-off artillery duels; pummel enemy rigging and hull lines, refusing hand-to-hand boarding.
- es Spanish Imperial Galleon / Carrack (*San Martín*)**

 - **Design:** High wooden forecastles/sterncastles designed as floating infantry castles for boarding.
 - **Artillery:** Heavy short-range cannon on unwieldy 2-wheel carriages; gunners had to climb outside hulls to reload.
 - **Tactical Goal:** Close range, grapple enemy ships, and unleash veteran infantry in boarding combat.

3. THE CATHOLIC PLOTS MATRIX: CONSPIRATORS, FOREIGN BACKING & WALSINGHAM'S COUNTER-ESPIONAGE

- 1569 Northern Earls:** Northumberland & Westmorland marched south with Catholic banners to restore Catholic Mass. Quashed by royal army; 450 rebels executed.
- 1571 Ridolfi Plot:** Italian banker Ridolfi plotted with Duke of Norfolk, Philip II, and Pope to murder Elizabeth. Cecil uncovered plot; Norfolk beheaded June 1572.
- 1583 Throckmorton:** French Duke of Guise planned invasion with Spanish funding. Walsingham's spies uncovered papers; Throckmorton executed; Bond of Association (1584).
- 1586 Babington Plot:** Anthony Babington sent coded beer-barrel letters to Mary Stuart agreeing to regicide. Phelippes cracked cipher; Mary executed Feb 1587.

4. THE ROAD TO WAR: COMMERCIAL RIVALRY, THE NETHERLANDS & DRAKE'S RAIDS (1572–87)

- 🇬🇧 Privateering & Silver Raids:** Drake raided Nombre de Dios (1572) and captured £140,000 in silver from the *Cacafuego* (1579). Elizabeth knighted Drake on *Golden Hind* in 1581, enraging Philip II.
- 🇳🇱 Treaty of Nonsuch (1585):** After 1584 Treaty of Joinville (France/Spain) and William the Silent's murder, Elizabeth signed Nonsuch, sending Dudley and 7,400 troops to aid Dutch Protestants.
- 🇪🇸 Cadiz Raid (April 1587):** Drake sailed into Cadiz harbour, destroyed 30 Spanish ships and burned seasoned barrel staves ("singeing the King of Spain's beard"), delaying the Armada invasion by a year.

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS

- **Papal Bull (1570):** *Regnans in Excelsis*: Pope Pius V excommunicated Elizabeth, releasing subjects from loyalty.
 - **Bond of Association (1584):** Pledge by Englishmen to execute anyone involved in an assassination attempt against Elizabeth.
 - **Singeing the King's Beard:** Drake's April 1587 raid on Cadiz harbour destroying 30 ships and delaying the Armada by a year.
 - **Culverin:** Long-range English bronze naval cannon mounted on truck carriages for rapid reloading.
- **Privateering:** State-licensed raiding of enemy merchant shipping by armed private vessels holding letters of marque.
 - **Treaty of Nonsuch (1585):** Official military alliance committing 7,400 English soldiers under Robert Dudley to aid Dutch rebels.
 - **Galleon:** A large, multi-decked warship designed for ocean navigation and long-range cannon fire.
 - **Battle of Gravelines (1588):** Decisive naval clash off Flanders where English artillery battered scattered Spanish warships.

2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY

- 1569: Revolt of the Northern Earls
- 1570: Papal Bull excommunicates Queen
- 1571: Ridolfi Plot uncovered
- 1577–80: Drake circumnavigates world
- 1583: Throckmorton Plot uncovered
- 1584: Treaty of Joinville (Spain/France)
- 1585: Treaty of Nonsuch signed
- 1586: Babington Plot ciphers cracked
- Feb 1587: Mary Stuart executed
- July–Aug 1588: Spanish Armada defeated

3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX

- **Sir Francis Walsingham:** Principal Secretary & Spymaster General; uncovered Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- **Sir Francis Drake:** Privateer, navigator, and vice-admiral; raided Cadiz in 1587 and commanded at Gravelines.
- **Duke of Medina Sidonia:** Spanish grandee appointed by Philip II to command the 130 ships of the Armada.
- **Duke of Parma:** Brilliant general commanding Spain's 27,000-man veteran Army of Flanders.
- **Anthony Babington:** Catholic gentleman whose coded letters to Mary Stuart triggered her trial and execution.
- **Sir John Hawkins:** Treasurer of the Navy; designed English race-built galleons and developed naval gunnery.

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.1 & 2.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (R1, R2, R3) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 2.1: PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME

1

/10

1. Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion?

R1

R2

R3

2. Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass?

R1

R2

R3

3. What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570?

R1

R2

R3

4. Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot?

R1

R2

R3

5. Who was Queen Elizabeth's Spymaster General from 1573?

R1

R2

R3

6. How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot?

R1

R2

R3

7. What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart's letters for Walsingham?

R1

R2

R3

8. What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth?

R1

R2

R3

9. In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587?

R1

R2

R3

10. Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt?

R1

R2

R3

ENQUIRY 2.2: RELATIONS WITH SPAIN

1

/10

11. Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth's sister Mary I?

R1

R2

R3

12. What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation?

R1

R2

R3

13. What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas?

R1

R2

R3

14. What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided enemy merchant ships?

R1

R2

R3

15. Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)?

R1

R2

R3

16. What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579?

R1

R2

R3

17. How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*?

R1

R2

R3

18. Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581?

R1

R2

R3

19. Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knightng Francis Drake?

R1

R2

R3

20. What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II's rule in 1566?

R1

R2

R3

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.3 & 2.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks’ topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 2.3: OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88

/ 10

21. Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584?

R1

R2

R3

22. What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584?

R1

R2

R3

23. What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels?

R1

R2

R3

24. Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands?

R1

R2

R3

25. What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth?

R1

R2

R3

26. Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands?

R1

R2

R3

27. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587?

R1

R2

R3

28. How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours?

R1

R2

R3

29. What famous phrase described Drake’s raid on Cadiz?

R1

R2

R3

30. What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada’s food storage?

R1

R2

R3

ENQUIRY 2.4: THE ARMADA

/ 10

31. How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588?

R1

R2

R3

32. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II?

R1

R2

R3

33. What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect?

R1

R2

R3

34. Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588?

R1

R2

R3

35. What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles?

R1

R2

R3

36. What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety?

R1

R2

R3

37. What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel?

R1

R2

R3

38. What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais?

R1

R2

R3

39. What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast?

R1

R2

R3

40. What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain?

R1

R2

R3

ENQUIRY 2.1 (Q1–10): 1. The Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland • 2. Durham Cathedral • 3. Regnans in Excelsis • 4. The Duke of Norfolk (Thomas Howard) • 5. Sir Francis Walsingham • 6. Inside the bungs of beer barrels • 7. Thomas Pheippes • 8. The Bond of Association • 9. Footrighingay Castle • 10. Approximately 450 rebels

ENQUIRY 2.3 (Q21–30): 21. William of Orange (William the Silent) • 22. The Treaty of Jolville • 23. The Treaty of Nonsuch • 24. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester • 25. Governor-General of the United Provinces • 26. The Duke of Parma (Alexander Farnese) • 27. Cadiz Harbour • 28. Approximately 30 ships • 29. “Singeing the King of Spain’s Beard” • 30. Seasoned oak barrel

ENQUIRY 2.4 (Q31–40): 31. 130 ships • 32. The Duke of Medina Sidonia • 33. The Duke of Parma’s Army of Flanders (27,000 troops) • 34. Lord Howard of Effingham • 35. Sir John Hawkins • 36. Culverins • 37. The tight Crescent Formation • 38. Eight Hellburners / Freships • 39. The Battle of Gravelines • 40. North around Scotland and the west coast of Ireland

ENQUIRY 2.2 (Q11–20): 11. King Philip II of Spain • 12. Roman Catholic • 13. The trade monopoly on Spanish New World colonies • 14. Privateers • 15. Sir Francis Drake • 16. The *Nuestra Señora de la Concepción* (nicknamed the *Cacafuego*) • 17. Over £140,000 (worth tens of millions today) • 18. On board the *Golden Hind* at Deptford • 19. He viewed Drake as a common pirate and thief of Spanish property • 20. The Netherlands (Spanish Netherlands)

Rotate booklet 180° to self-mark retrieval drills in green pen

PUPIL: 	TARGET GRADE:	PREDICTED:	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 2					
#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
2.1	ENQUIRY 2.1: PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME Do Now Retrieval (p. 4): [/ 10]	p. 5	Q1(a) Feature: the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569) [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q1(b) Feature: Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q1(c) Feature: the Ridolfi Plot (1571) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q2 Explain Why: Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587. [12m]		[/ 12]
2.2	ENQUIRY 2.2: RELATIONS WITH SPAIN Do Now Retrieval (p. 8): [/ 10]	p. 9	Q1(a) Feature: commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q1(b) Feature: Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q1(c) Feature: English privateering against Spanish treasure fleets [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q3 Essay: 'Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening... [16m]		[/ 16]
2.3	ENQUIRY 2.3: OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585-88 Do Now Retrieval (p. 12): [/ 10]	p. 13	Q1(a) Feature: the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q1(b) Feature: Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q1(c) Feature: the Treaty of Joinville (1584) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q2 Explain Why: Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebel... [12m]		[/ 12]
2.4	ENQUIRY 2.4: THE ARMADA Do Now Retrieval (p. 16): [/ 10]	p. 17	Q1(a) Feature: the Spanish invasion plan of 1588 [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q1(b) Feature: the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q1(c) Feature: English naval tactics during the Armada campaign [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q3 Essay: 'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior... [16m]		[/ 16]

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ENQUIRY 2.1 Plots and revolts at home The Revolt of the Northern Earls • 1569 LESSON Read Online 20-Q QUIZ Self-Marking Quiz Attempt: [] 1st [] 2nd [] 3rd Score: [/ 20] Date: ____/____/____	ENQUIRY 2.2 Relations with Spain Political and religious rivalry between E... LESSON Read Online 20-Q QUIZ Self-Marking Quiz Attempt: [] 1st [] 2nd [] 3rd Score: [/ 20] Date: ____/____/____	ENQUIRY 2.3 Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585-... The Dutch Revolt and English involvem... LESSON Read Online 20-Q QUIZ Self-Marking Quiz Attempt: [] 1st [] 2nd [] 3rd Score: [/ 20] Date: ____/____/____	ENQUIRY 2.4 The Armada The Spanish invasion plan and leadership... LESSON Read Online 20-Q QUIZ Self-Marking Quiz Attempt: [] 1st [] 2nd [] 3rd Score: [/ 20] Date: ____/____/____
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